



Our wedding on March 17, 1990, with best man, John Suske, and maid of honor, Janet Cameron. We were broke! We did the whole wedding for \$10,000.

(Nick Czudjowycz, Einesport Productions)

“Yeah, yeah, yeah,” I can hear you saying. “But that’s just the cost of doing things right.” According to whom? According to the marital-industrial complex, the vicious cabal headed by the insidious wedding-planner industry, cosigned by celebrity rags that make people feel as if they have to treat their Big Day as the one time in their lives when they can act like they’re famous? That’s what’s really going on at these monster weddings. Couples may think they’re creating “lasting memories,” but what they’re really doing is creating a one-day spectacle to show off status they don’t have. Look, unless you’re a Kardashian and you’ve figured out how to get your wedding sponsored by major corporations, you can’t afford doves and carriages. So get real, folks.

This is the part where I get to be more smug than usual: My wife and I spent \$10,000 on our wedding, *including* a honeymoon in Barbados. True, we didn’t have a lot of money at the time, and were I not a cheap bastard, we could have splurged a bit more. But Linda and I are cut from the same cloth. We agreed on a sane and sound